

NORMANDY

THE BLOODY POCKET

D-DAY TO FALAISE 1944

Rules of Play

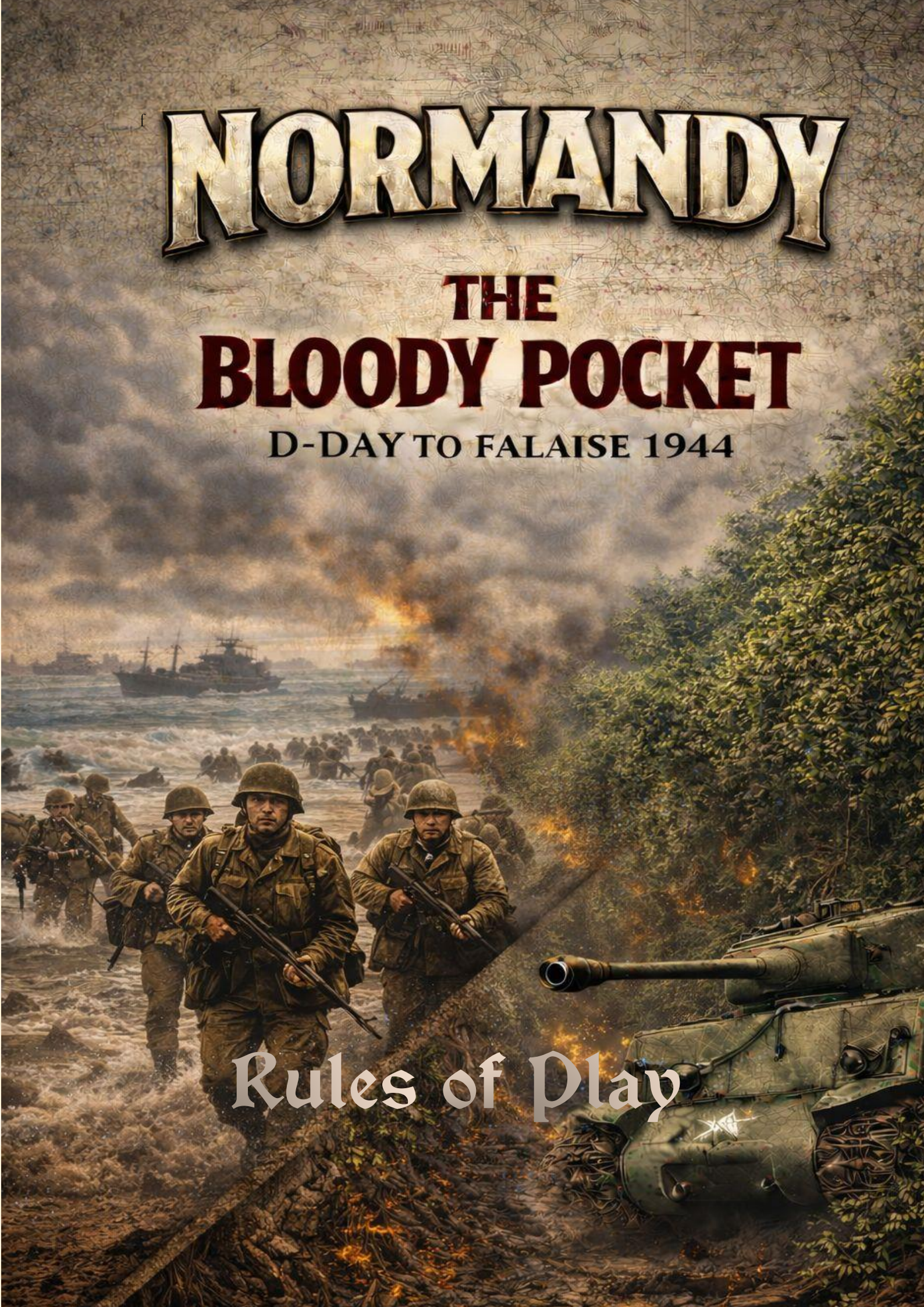


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INTRODUCTION

Normandy: The Bloody Pocket is the first game in an intended series, *States of Siege: Operational Series*. It is a solitaire game telling the story of the 1944 Normandy Campaign through its key events and decision points. The game begins with the D-Day invasion and proceeds as you attempt to stop the advance of four Allied Armies; all are bent on destroying the German Army in Normandy and thus liberating occupied France.

Historical event cards dictate the movement of the Allied armies and give the player a number of Actions to conduct each turn. The game is played through three chronological Event decks, and if you can either hold the Falaise Gap space through to the end of the third deck you win!

GAME EQUIPMENT

Parts Inventory

- 1 24" x 10" map
- 43 game pieces
- 48 Headline cards (24 grey, 12 blue, and 12 yellow)
- Various markers (Strength value modifiers, Siege, Fortified Villages, Resource markers)
- 1 Rules booklet
- 1 Playbook
- 1 six-sided Die

The Game Map



Text in shaded boxes, like this, provides the voice of the game's designer, who is addressing you to explain an idea or concept that is not, itself, a Rule or a Case.

The game map depicts the area of Normandy, plus a box representing those parts of Brittany, in which fighting occurred. The *Falaise Gap* space is the central hub of the game's activity and four coloured tracks emanate out from it.

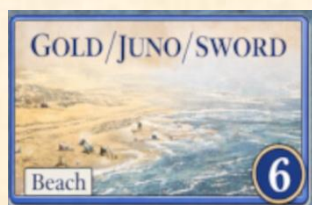
The spaces with "B" as a code represent bocage (hedgerow) country while spaces with "F" represent fortresses.

The two beach spaces, marked with "Beach", off the coast represent the five D-Day beaches: Utah, Omaha, Gold, Juno and Sword. They have been combined into two spaces; one where the American armies landed; the other where the British and Canadian armies invaded.

The beach spaces can be counter-attacked but not occupied by German forces.

Spaces with "H" are hill spaces.

There are also various charts and boxes for "In Transit", "Strategic Reserve" and "Eliminated" units, a map key and three Resource Tracks for Transport, Supply and Hitler Approval.



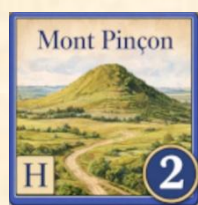
Beach Space



Bocage Space



Fortress Space



Hill Space



Town Space

Unlike other games in the States of Siege series, all map spaces have an inherent defensive value. (See the terrain key on the map).

The Four Boxes with Army designations are the starting points for those armies. Note that at the start of the game, British 1 Corps uses the 1st Canadian Army track (until the Canadian Army is activated by an event).

Event Cards

There are three decks of Event Cards indicated by the background color of the headline at the top: grey, blue and yellow. These cards reveal the game's narrative and drive the enemy forces against the player, giving the number of actions available to the player listing available Allied air power, German resource level changes and a historical narrative.



Unlike most SoS games, historical text does not appear on the card (to save space). The card descriptions can be found in the Playbook.



WEATHER	
Die Roll	Effects
1	Overcast – No air power available; +2 DRM for Supply, Transport Resource Rolls
2–3	Partly Clear – 1 Jabo available; +1 DRM on Carpet Bombing table (if applicable)
4–6	Clear – all Jabos available; No DRM on Carpet Bombing table (if applicable)

CARPET BOMBING	
Die Roll	Effects
1–4	No Effect: Use +2 Carpet Bombing
5	Use +1 Carpet Bombing
6	Attack cancelled

SIEGE TABLE	
Die Roll	Effects
1–2	No Effect
3	Eliminate 1 combat step
4	Eliminate 2 combat steps
5	Eliminate 3 combat steps
6	Space captured

DRMs:

- -1 if defense-attack differential is >= 6
- -2 if defense-attack differential is >= 10
- -1 if no air power
- +1 if no combat steps in fortress

In Transit



Strategic Reserve



Attack/Defense Values

0	1	2	3	4
5	6	7	8	9
10	11	12	13	14
15	16	17	18	19

2

U.S. 3rd Army
Starts Avranches

BRITTANY



US VIII Corps Only

US VIII Corps

Rennes
T 4

US XV Corps

Mortain
B 3

Avranches
B 4/8

Coutances
B 6

St-Lô
B 5

Carentan
B 9

Mont Pinçon
H 2

Tilly
B 4

Utah/Omah Beach
10

U.S. 1st Army

Cherbourg
T 7

Valognes
B 8

B

U.S. 2nd Army

T

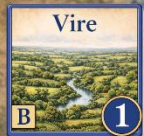
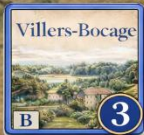
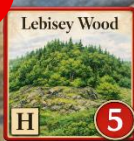
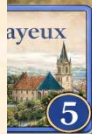
NORMANDY

THE BLOODY POCKET

D-DAY TO FALAISE 1944



4



SEQUENCE OF PLAY

Card Draw Phase

Weather Phase

Resources Phase

Military Phase

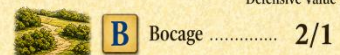
Action Phase

- Launch Counter-Attack
- Deploy Reinforcements to Map
- Redeploy Combat Units
- Refit Combat Units
- Increase Resources
- Fortify Villages (3)
- Move Actions to Reserve Box

Housekeeping Phase

MAP KEY

Defensive Value



B Bocage 2/1



T Town 1



H Hill 2



B Beach 2



F Fortress 4



Fortified Villages 3



Falaise Gap 1

6



6

5

4

3

2

1

0

Transport



6

5

4

3

2

1

0

Supply



6

5

4

3

2

1

0

-1

REMOVED
FROM COMMAND

Hitler
Approval

SETTING UP THE GAME

Follow these steps to set up the game:

1. Place each of the three invading Allied Army units on their starting boxes (1st US Army; 2nd British Army; 1st Canadian Army).
2. Place the US 3rd Army in its starting box next to Avranches. This army is inactive at the start of the game.

1st US Army begins the game with its “3” side face up, 3rd US Army begins with strength “4”; the two British-Canadian Corps begin the game on their “2” side.
3. 21st Panzer, two Nebelwerfer and one 88mm FlaK unit begin in Bayeux
4. Two Nebelwerfer and one 88mm Flak Unit begin in Lebissey Wood
5. One 88mm Flak Unit begins in Carentan
6. Place the German resource markers as follows:
 - Place the Transport marker on the 5 box of the “Transport” track
 - Place the Hitler Approval marker on the 6 box of the “Hitler Approval” track
 - Place the Supply marker on the 4 box of the “Supply” track
7. If using the optional Attack/Defense strength markers, place these on the “0” space of the Attack/Defense Values track
8. Sort the cards into their three epochs (Early, Mid, Late). Set aside the Mid and Late decks for now.
9. Place all the other markers to the side of the board

Sort the cards into their three epochs (see 2.3). Set aside the Cobra and Falaise decks for now

Counters

The cardboard game pieces represent the four invading Allied Armies, one marker for each of the three resource tracks (Transport, Supply and Hitler Approval), and markers representing various military units (Allied fighter-bombers [jabos], a Carpet Bombing marker and pieces representing the German Panzer units involved in the Normandy campaign.

There are also pieces representing Nebelwerfers (German rocket artillery) and FlaK 88mm anti-tank guns, Siege markers, Fortress markers, and markers for Generals Patton, Montgomery and Model.

There also DRM (Die Roll Modifier) and Attack/Defense Strength modifier markers which remind the player when DRMs should be applied to die rolls or modifiers applied to attacking or defending forces in battles.

Allied Armies

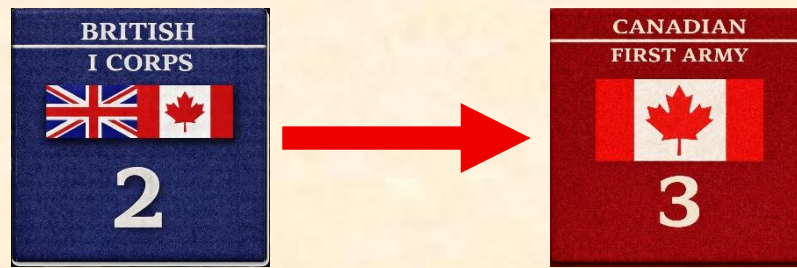


The armies represent the forces arrayed against the German army in Normandy. Armies start with a weaker “3” battle value, but are flipped to their “4” side by event card (except 1st Canadian Army).

US 3rd Army starts with its battle value at “4”, but is broken down into its two corps; VIII and XV corps, as VIII Corps was diverted to Brittany.

The British 2nd Army is initially represented by its two component corps, XXX Corps and I Corps (both value 2). When the Upgrade Armies (Card #28) is played, XXX Corps is flipped to become British 2nd Army and I Corps is flipped to become Canadian 1st Army as shown here:





The Canadian 1st Army was activated on July 23rd; up to that point Canadian formations served under British command (1st Corps in British 2nd Army). To reflect this, the two attacking British-Canadian formations are XXX Corps and I Corps, even though the tracks are marked British 2nd Army and Canadian 1st Army.

Track Markers

Transport



Hitler Approval



Supply

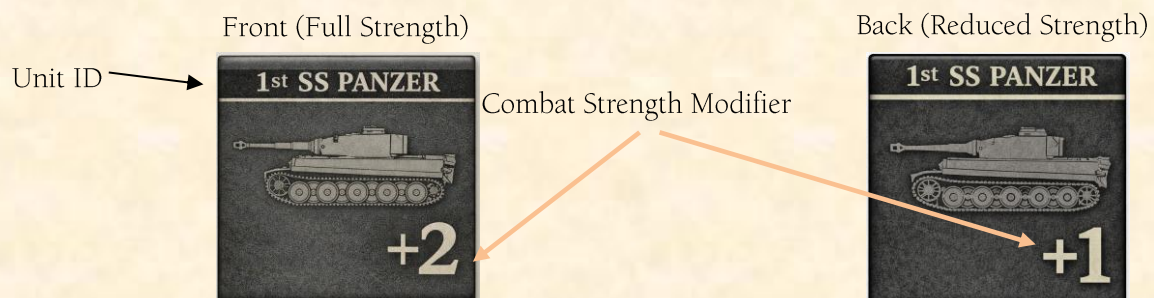


The three resource markers have a Base Level on their front. Transport and Supply do not change but Hitler Approval changes to 4 following Assassination attempt. This is the number the player needs to roll higher than to increase that resource's level on its respective track.

German units are considered to be abstractly present in every space on the board, but these forces can be augmented by panzer units, nebelwerfers and FlaK anti-tank units.

Once German panzer units are defeated in combat they are flipped to their reverse side; the next time they are defeated in combat they are eliminated. Reduced (+1) Panzer Units can also be withdrawn to the Strategic Reserve Box to be refitted (restored to full strength).

Panzer Units



Note that SS Panzer units have black counters, Wehrmacht Panzer units have blue counters. For example, here is 2nd Panzer division. Note, this has no effect on gameplay. Additionally, there are several “Kampfgruppen” (ad hoc battle groups) which come into play via event card later in the game.



Other German Combat Markers

Nebelwerfer



flaK 88 mm Anti-Tank



101st Tiger Battalion



Nebelwerfer units are eliminated if they lose a combat in the space they are attacking.

Flak 88 units begin at +2 (Full Strength) and are flipped to +1 (Reduced Strength) when they take a loss.

These units provide a defensive DRM when present in a space being attacked by an Allied unit. Panzer units and Nebelwerfer units also provide an offensive bonus when attacking Allied units.

Michael Wittmann's 101st Tiger Battalion provides a one-off +3 DRM when activated by the appropriate event card and is then removed from play (event card 9, "Wittmann")

Commanders

There are also three commanders in the game, which are activated by event-card and provide one-off DRMs/Strength modifications for the units stipulated on the cards (Allies) or any German space in the case of Model.

If the army is not specified, e.g., Card #14 *Operation Epsom* apply the modifier to the first army listed.

Note that Model cannot be deployed until Card #38 *Model Takes Command* is drawn. If a card specifies Model as a resource for the player, ignore that reference.

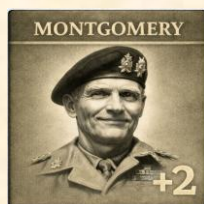
All Commanders' modifiers apply on defense **and** attack.

Model is allocated to a space in the Resources phase; Player's choice.

Patton



Montgomery



Model



Allied Air Power

Markers representing Allied Fighter Bombers (“Jabos”) and Heavy Bombers used in a tactical role (“Carpet Bombing”). Each is deployed via Event Card and provides an attack modifier, but is dependent on weather:

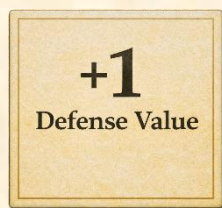
Jabos



Carpet Bombing



Other Markers



Attack and Defense Value markers are used as a reminder of modifiers listed on the event cards. The DRM markers are used as reminders for DRMs (listed on event cards) to the Resource Checks and Resource Rolls.

SEQUENCE OF PLAY

The full deck of cards enters play in three “epochs”: Grey - Early (#1-25), Blue- Mid (#26-37) and yellow - Late (#38-48)

Cards #1 and #2 are the first two cards of the invasion deck.
Remove cards 1 and 2 and play those as the first two cards of the game. Then draw a card randomly for each subsequent turn.

The mid and late decks are shuffled in when the appropriate event card is revealed.

The sequence of play is as follows: -

1. **Event Phase.** Reveal the top card in the draw deck and place it, face up, on the discard pile. That card becomes the new Current Event card that you must resolve that turn.
2. **Weather Phase.** Roll on the weather table to determine the weather; this will decide how much air power is available to the Allies and whether there are any DRMs on Supply/Transport Resource Rolls. Note, no weather roll is made when card #13 *The Great Storm* is drawn (weather is automatically overcast). Roll on Carpet Bombing table if required.
3. **Resource Phase.** Place Jabos, Carpet Bombing, DRM/modifier markers. Adjust Changes to Resource Tracks. Add reinforcements to In Transit or Strategic Resource box.
4. **Military Phase.** Move all active Allied armies as indicated on the Current Event card. If any advance into the Falaise Gap (0) space, you immediately lose the game. Resolve combat between the advancing armies and the defense value of the space being moved into.
5. **Action Phase.** The Current Event card usually confers a number of Actions to the player. These are used to: -
 - Launch offensives against Allied Armies to push them back
 - Deploy reinforcements to the Strategic Reserve box and/or the map
 - Redeploy Panzer units to the Strategic Reserve box
 - Refit reduced Panzer Units (bring to full strength) residing in the Strategic Reserve box
 - Attempt to increase the resources on the resource tracks
 - Fortify Villages
 - Put 1 or 2 Actions into the Strategic Reserve Box
6. **Housekeeping Phase:** Remove all JABO, Carpet Bombing and DRM markers from the map. If the end of the first deck is reached, check the automatic allied victory condition.

A complete game continues until all the cards from all three decks have been revealed and played or victory/defeat occurs.

RESOURCES

When each card is drawn, add all DRM/Modifier markers to the board where specified on the event card. This will be:

- DRM markers on the Resource Tracks (Resource Roll and/or Resource Check DRMs)
- Attack/Defense Modifiers for the Allied Armies
- Commander markers deployed to the correct space
- German Reinforcements deployed to the *In Transit* or *Strategic Reserves* Box
- Adjust Resource levels according to event card

D-Day Landings

The first two card of the Invasion (first) deck are the D-Day landings. Roll a die for each of the three invading armies. If the result is greater than (>) 1, the British and Canadians successfully land on the Gold-Juno-Sword space (roll separately for each army).

If the result is greater than (>) 2, the US First Army successfully lands on Utah-Omaha beach.

Omaha-Utah tended to have stronger beach defenses than those in the British-Canadian sector, hence the higher defense value

to have a permanent lodgement.

The player, with his 1 Action on turn 1 could:

Launch an attack against British 2nd Army from Bayeux, or against 1 Corps from Lebiesey Woods.

Launch an attack against US 1st Army from Carentan. Beach boxes have a defense value of 2.

Note that the player only gets 1 Action on turn 1 so may not wish to make any attacks, since reinforcements are due to arrive.

If the player launches an attack against a beach box containing two units (1 British and 1 Canadian) he only attacks the Army of his own track and only that army is pushed back to the start box in the event the player wins the battle.

Example 1

The player rolls a 3 for 1st US Army and places the army marker in the Utah/Omaha beach box. Now the German player decides to use his 1 action to counter-attack the beachhead. He decides not to use the Nebelwerfers in Carentan so it is a basic die roll against the US 1st Army battle value of 3 plus 1 for terrain.

He needs to roll a 5 or 6. He rolls a 5 so the US 1st Army is forced back to its starting box.

On turn 2, the US 1st Army advances to the Utah/Omaha beach box without needing a die roll.

Note that if the player had not counter-attacked successfully, the US 1st Army advance would have meant it attacked Carentan.

i.e., any armies which fail to land on turn 1, automatically land on turn 2.

Example 2

Both British 2nd Army and 1st Corps have successfully landed at Gold-Juno-Sword beach. On his turn the player decides to launch a counter attack from Bayeux against British 2nd Army. Defense Value is 3 + 2 for the beach. The Germans use 21st Panzer and two Nebelwerfer for a total DRM of +4. Any roll other than 1 will succeed.

The player wins the battle and British 2nd Army moves back to its offshore starting box. 1 Corps remains in the beach box. The German forces take no losses and remain in Bayeux.

On turn 2 the British 2nd Army advances to the Gold-Juno-Sword beach box without needing a roll.

Given the initial disposition of German formations, it would have been virtually impossible to throw all three Allied armies back in to the sea. Although see Optional Rule 11.1 which has two additional panzer divisions close to the coast to explore this option.

Reinforcements

Any [Panzer Division] reinforcements due must roll against the current Transport level. If the roll is LESS THAN the Transport level, the reinforcements reach Normandy and move in to the Strategic Reserve box where they await being released for deployment by Hitler. This roll does not cost an action.

Exception: Kampfgruppen/Nebelwerfer/Flak 88 units move directly to either the map or Strategic Reserve box. This costs no action (no rolls needed).

If the Transport Check fails, the reinforcements move instead to the “In Transit” box.

Where there are reinforcements and a change in the Hitler Approval level, the reinforcement/deployment rolls come first; then the Hitler Approval level is increased/reduced.

During the Normandy campaign, Hitler maintained strict control over the release and deployment of the Panzer divisions; hence in the game, the player must pass a Hitler Approval roll in order to deploy, or re-deploy any panzer units.

Example

On Turn 1 Panzer Lehr and 12th SS Panzer are listed as reinforcements. The current Transport level is 5. For each of these formations, a roll of less than (<) 5 will move the units into the Strategic Reserve box. These reinforcement rolls do not cost an action.

Once in the reserve box, in order to now deploy these units on to the map, the player would have to spend an action to roll for Hitler Approval (currently 5). Since only one action is available on turn 1, only one of these two panzer formations could be deployed, and this would require a roll of less than (<) 5 on the Hitler track.

Note that units in the In Transit box which pass the Transport Check and have moved to the Strategic Reserve Box can be deployed to the map for 1 Action (must pass Hitler Approval check) or they can be left in the Strategic Reserve Box for future deployment.

When deploying to the map, reinforcements can be placed in any German-controlled space, i.e. not in or behind the Allied Armies on their tracks.

Hitler Approval/Releasing Panzer Units

Once Panzer formations reach Normandy, they move to the Strategic Reserve box. If a Hitler roll is passed, the player may deploy the Panzer units to any German controlled space. The stacking limit is 3 panzer units, 3 Nebelwerfer, and 3 88mm FlaK Units per space. Kampfgruppen count as a panzer formation for stacking purposes.

Hitler Approval is increased by 1 for all successful attacks.

Hitler Approval is decreased by 1 for all unsuccessful defenses of a space where there are Panzer Units present.

Hitler's strict control of the Panzer units also extended to interference in their operational, and even tactical, deployment on occasion. A loss would enrage Hitler as he often accused Generals of misusing these valuable assets.

Supplies

If the Supply level reaches 6, all German defense values are increased by 1. If the supply level reaches 0, no attacks may be launched involving Panzer units until the supply level is increased to at least one. Other attacks (not involving Panzer units) are unaffected.

Play Note: It will be quite rare for the player to attack an Allied army without Panzer formations being involved, at least in the early part of the game, due to the low odds of success.

One Supply Point is deducted from the supply track where panzer units are involved in an attack, including 101st Tiger Battalion and Kampfgruppen.

If 101st Tiger Battalion is drawn when supply is zero, the unit is lost permanently.

Counter-Attacks

Any Allied army may be attacked whether or not there are German formations adjacent to that space; the German units simply provide extra DRMs and make the attack more likely to succeed.

Prior to the attack, combat units may be moved to the attacked space from Strategic Reserve (the latter requires a Hitler Roll).

If the player attacks and the attack contains one or more Panzer units, winning the battle results in an increase of 1 in the Hitler Approval level.

For the attack to succeed the player must roll GREATER THAN the combined Army Strength Rating + terrain + DRM.

The cost is 1 Supply Point (total) if any Panzer units are involved in the attack

Where German units are available, they add their DRMs to the die roll for the attack. Flak 88 units cannot attack.

Where German formations involved in an attack fail to win a combat, take 1 loss: either one Panzer unit is flipped to its “1” side (or eliminated if already on the “1” side) or eliminate a nebelwerfer. Attacks involving one or more panzer units cost 1 Supply point in total.

If the attack fails, German units remain in their space.

If it succeeds, at least one combat unit must advance to the attacked space (player’s choice).

Exception never advance to beach spaces.

Allied armies may only be pushed back one space per turn; turn the counter sideways once an army has retreated to remind yourself that no further attacks are possible on this unit.

Example 1

The US 1st Army is in Carentan. With no German DRMs the player would require a die roll GREATER THAN (>) 5 to cause the army to retreat (3 for the army +2 for the bocage).

Example 2

The US 1st Army is in Carentan. The 17th SS Panzer Grenadier unit and a Nebelwerfer are in Valognes. A +1 (reduced) Panzer Lehr is in the Strategic Reserve Box.

For 1 Action the player moves the 17th SS Unit to Carentan. For 1 further Action he attempts to redeploy Panzer Lehr from the Strategic Reserve Box. He passes a Hitler Roll and moves Panzer Lehr to Carentan.

Now the DRMs are +3 (+2 for 17th SS PzGrd, +1 for Panzer Lehr) so the player would need >5 with +3 DRM. If he rolls a 2 with the DRMs that would equal 5 (not enough to win). So, he’s going to need a 3 or more.

The player rolls a 1. Panzer Lehr is eliminated and 17SS is reduced and moved back to Valognes. Hitler Approval is reduced by 1.

The Supply Points marker is moved down the Supply track by 1.

Redeploy/Refit Panzer Units, Move Other Units 1 Space

For 1 action, all units can move 1 space. This does not require a Transport Check. (Allows units left behind when Germans counter attack to “catch up” or to retreat one space).

For one action, the player may move a panzer unit to the Strategic Reserve Box. He must pass a Transport Check for the move to succeed.

Once there, these units can:

- Remain in the box
- Refit (reduced Panzer Units are restored to full strength), costs 1 Action
- Deploy back to map (must pass Hitler Approval Check), costs 1 Action

Panzer Units (only) must be redeployed via the Strategic Reserve box. Nebelwerfer and Flak88 units can never be redeployed. Where they are initially placed on the map is where they remain until eliminated (or moved 1 space, as described above)

Refit allows reduced strength (+1) Panzer formations to be restored full strength (+2); this does not apply to Kampfgruppen.

Units in a Fortress or Fortified Villages space under siege may not be redeployed out of that space while the siege continues.

Sieges



If the difference between the Defensive Value of N Caen, S Caen, Lorient, Brest (including defending units) and the Allied Army [modified] Attack Strength is greater than or equal to 6, then a Siege is declared. Place a Siege marker in the fortress space.

Similarly, use this rule for player Fortified Villages.

Each turn the Allied Army is designated to attack on a card, roll on the Siege Table.

Die Role

- | | |
|-----|--------------------------|
| 1-2 | No Effect |
| 3 | Eliminate 1 combat step |
| 4 | Eliminate 2 combat step |
| 5 | Eliminate 3 combat steps |
| 6 | Space captured |

DRMs:

- 1 if defense-attack differential is ≥ 6
- 2 if defense-attack differential is ≥ 10
- 1 if no air support in air attack
- +1 if no units in the fortress

If a modified 6 is rolled, all units in the fortress are eliminated.

Example

N. Caen is defended by three full strength Panzer divisions, three nebelwerfers and three 88 FlaK units (the maximum defensive fire power that can ever be in a space, excluding General Model being present).

The Defense Strength is 4 (Fortress) + 6 (pz divs) + 6 (88s) + 3 (Nebelwerfers) = 19

Attacking is the Canadian First Army with two jabos (2), carpet bombing (2) and General Montgomery (2) for a total of 6.

Since the Allies cannot win this (DV – AV is 13), a siege is declared.

Let's assume the attackers have 1 Jabo in support. The difference is 13 so there will be a -2 DRM on the Siege Table roll. The player rolls a "6", modified to a 4, so two German combat points are eliminated. The player chooses to eliminate two nebelwerfer units.

Resource Rolls

At a cost of one action, the player may attempt to improve the level of any of his three resources by making a resource roll. If the roll is GREATER THAN (>) the resource's base level, increase that resource by one.

If the weather is overcast (including when Card #13 *The Great Storm* is drawn), there is a +1 DRM to Transport and Supply Resource Rolls. These are the only DRMs that apply to Resource Rolls.

All the DRMs listed on the cards apply to Resource Checks, not Resource Rolls

Example

The player's Supply base level is "3". The weather is clear. A die roll GREATER THAN (>) 3 will result in the Supply level increasing to 3.

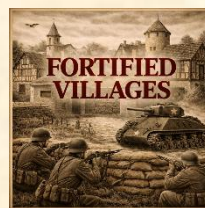
If the weather is overcast, a roll > 2 will result in supply level increasing by 1.

As many resource rolls may be made as desired per turn, subject to the number of actions available.

To a large degree, the ability of the German forces in France to move reinforcements and supplies within and to Normandy was affected by the availability of Allied Air Power. This rule reflects that. When the Allied aircraft were grounded it was far easier to reinforce/move/supply the formations in Normandy.

For a cost of 3 actions, the player may fortify any space under German control (except the Falaise Gap space). The space becomes a *Fortified Villages* space (place the Fortified Villages marker on the space) and remains so until captured by an Allied Army. It follows all fortress rules, except that it has a defense value of 3. It can be placed under siege as normal.

If a Fortified Village space is lost, remove the marker. The space reverts to its base type/defense value.



This rule represents the German ability to fortify Normandy villages and towns, transforming stone buildings and ancient enclosed farms into strongpoints.

Put Actions into the Strategic Reserve Box

The player may move 1 or 2 actions in the Strategic Reserve box for later use. There can only ever be a maximum of two actions in the box.



ALLIED ARMY MOVEMENT

During the Army Movement Phase, the Current Event card specifies which Armies must be moved along their respective tracks. Generally, these armies move a single box closer to the Falaise Gap (i.e., to the next consecutively lowered box. Occasionally, armies will retreat one space (i.e., further away from the Falaise Gap); usually as a result of a successful German attack,

Inactive Army: the US Third Army begins the game inactive; it is activated automatically when the US First Army reaches the Avranches space.

Defensive Values of Spaces. Unlike other States of Siege games, each and every space on the map has an inherent defensive value. These are listed on the game map key. For example, bocage (round) spaces have a defensive value of two, although this reduces to one when the Sherman Rhino event card is played.

Additionally, the intrinsic defense values of the spaces can be augmented by the placement of German combat units: Panzer divisions, Nebelwerfer units, and FlaK 88mm anti tank units. These units add a further combat DRM to the base defensive value.

The defensive values are as follows:

- [1] Gold-Juno-Sword
- [2] Utah –Omaha
- [1] Towns
- [2, later 1 for Allied attacks] Bocage
- [2] Hills
- [4] Fortresses: N.Caen/S.Caen/Brest/Lorient
- [3] Fortified Villages created by player
- [1] Falaise Gap

Allied Army Attacks

When an Allied unit is to advance into a space, carry out the following procedure.

1. Start with the terrain value of the space. Add the defensive value of any defending German units.
2. Calculate the Attack modifiers and DRMs of the attacking Allied army. These could be modifiers from cards, or DRMs from counters (Generals, JABOS, Carpet Bombing).
3. Calculate the Attack Strength
4. Roll the die. If the die roll plus the Attack Strength is GREATER THAN (>) the defense value, the advance has succeeded and the Allied unit moves in to the space.

If the modified die roll is LESS THAN OR EQUAL TO ($\leq$) defense value, the advancing unit is halted and simply remains in its current space; it does not advance.

Example

On Turn 3, the event card drawn is #14 *Operation Epsom*. The weather is overcast. The military section shows advances by 2nd British and 1st Canadian army so 2nd British will attack Bayeux (space 5 on the British 2nd Army track is a town with a defense value of 1).

The Air Power section lists Jabos and Carpet Bombing but since the weather is overcast these are **not** available this turn.

Where the card says +1 Attack Strength 2nd BRIT, this means an additional +1 to the overall Attack Strength

Bayeux contains 21st Panzer (+2) plus two Nebelwerfer rocket units (+2) and one Nebelwerfer giving a defensive DRM of +5.

Total Defense Strength = 6 (1 for Bayeux plus 5 modifiers)

Total Attack Strength = 3 (+1 Attack Strength listed on card, +2 Montgomery)

Allied Army must roll GREATER THAN defense strength [6] to advance, with +3 Attack Strength this becomes a 4 or higher.

Now the player rolls a 4

Total attack value is 7. So, the Allies advance. German player takes two losses and retreats the remainder of his units one space to Tilly.

Note that a 1 always fails and a 6 always succeeds (exception; 6 does not automatically succeed for fortresses or fortified villages).

If the Attack Value is LESS THAN OR EQUAL TO ($\leq$) Defense Value – Attack fails, German defenders must take 1 loss (no advance)

If the Attack Value > Defense Value – Attack succeeds, German defenders must take 1 loss and retreat to next space on track. Allied Army advances into the attacked space.

Even if the German defenders hold off the Allied Advance, they still must take a loss. This simulates the gradual attrition and loss of combat cohesion of the German forces in Normandy.

Allied Air Power

The Allied air power available is dependent on the weather.

The weather is decided when each card is drawn using the following turn:

- | | |
|-----|--|
| 1-2 | Overcast: No air power available |
| 3-4 | Partly Clear: 1 Jabo available; +1 DRM on Carpet Bombing table (if applicable) |
| 5-6 | Clear: 2 Jabos available, no DRM on Carpet Bombing table (if applicable) |

If only one Jabo is available and 2 or more are allocated on the card, the first army listed receives the DRM.

Overcast gives +1 DRM on Transport/Supply Resource Rolls; see *Resource Rolls*.

When Carpet Bombing is listed as an air asset, roll for each army listed to advance. Apply any DRM to that army.

The carpet bombing table will determine if the carpet bombing has any negative effect on the attack due to “creep back” (friendly fire). Carpet bombing is allocated to each army listed on the Military section of the card. Only some event cards have carpet bombing attacks so this rule will often be redundant.

- | | |
|-----|---|
| 1-4 | No effect; use the +2 Carpet Bombing marker |
| 5 | Use the +1 Carpet Bombing marker |
| 6 | Carpet Bombing mission cancelled (remove Carpet Bombing marker) |

The Carpet bombing table, i.e., the use of strategic air assets for operational objectives in support of ground forces, reflects the ambivalently view held by ground forces, due to the nigh-inevitable friendly casualties caused by bombers dropping their ordnance short of the aiming point, either through error or "bomb creep".

Note Allied air power is only used for close air support of ground attacks; it is not used to defend armies against attack.

The effect of Allied Air Power on the interdiction of supplies and reinforcements was a major factor in the outcome of the Normandy campaign. This has been abstracted into the various losses of resources on the cards.

There are three types of German defensive units which can appear on the board defending German controlled spaces: Panzer units, Nebelwerfer Rocket Artillery and FlaK 88mm anti-tank gun units. Kampfgruppen act like regular Panzer units in all combat cases.

All these units appear as reinforcements on the Event Cards; except 21st Panzer, two Nebelwerfer and one 88mm FlaK unit which start the game in the Bayeux space.

If German units successfully defend a space, they will always take 1 or 2 losses depending on the result. The losses can be a Nebelwerfer or Flak 88 unit eliminated, or reducing a Panzer unit from +2 to +1, or eliminating a +1 Panzer Unit.

If they lose the combat and the Allied army advances in to that space, after taking losses, all units retreat one space.

The 101st Tiger Battalion represents Michael Wittman's formation and can be used as a one-off unit, either defending or attacking. Once involved in any combat it is eliminated.

German Counter-Attacks

One of the key elements of the game is to occasionally attempt to force enemy Allied Armies to retreat.

In *Normandy: The Bloody Pocket*, certain units can add their combat modifiers to the attack, namely Panzer units and Nebelwerfer units.

There is a cost in supply of one supply point per Panzer Unit involved in an attack including kampfguppen. It is not necessary to use German combat units in an attack; an Allied army can be

attacked without such support, or the player can choose to attack with just nebelwerfer rocket units which cost no supply points.

If the player wins the combat, some, none or all of the panzer units/nebelwerfers can advance to the previously Allied occupied space.

If the player loses the combat, he suffers one loss.

If the German attacker strength plus a die roll is GREATER THAN the Allied Army defense value (plus any modifiers from cards) the German attacker retake the space and force the Allied Army back one space.

Example

Bayeux is defended by 2nd British Army (defense strength 3) plus a +1 DRM (for the town) giving a total defense strength of 4.

Panzer Lehr (+2) plus one Nebelwerfer unit attack the town giving a DRM of +3.

A roll of 2 or more will give the Germans an Attack Strength GREATER THAN 4 and will win the battle.

The player rolls a “2” meaning the Germans re-take Bayeux from the British. The British 2nd Army retreats back to the Gold-Juno-Sword Beach space.

This attack costs the German player 1 supply point; additionally, if he loses, Panzer Lehr is reduced to its +1 side and Hitler Approval drops by one point (see Hitler Approval, below).

Hitler Approval

The player must pass a “Hitler Approval” roll in order to perform the following actions:

- Deploy a panzer unit from/to the reserve box
- Avoid having to carry out “Hitler Interventions” as defined by several Event Cards.

The player rolls a die, if the result is LESS THAN OR EQUAL TO ($\leq$) the current Hitler Approval level the check has passed.

For “Hitler Intervention” cards, the player must fail the check for the intervention to go ahead. (Exception: the “Mortain Counter Attack” (card #32) always occurs; no roll is required).

For the “Mortain Counter Attack”, the start space (the Luttich space) is the space adjacent to US 1st Army.

In addition to resource rolls by the player and changes indicated on the cards, the Hitler Approval level rises by one when a combat is won and drops by one when a combat is lost in which panzer units (not Kampfgruppen) are involved (defense only).

Additionally, the Hitler approval level drops by two when Brest or Lorient are lost

in August 1944, Hitler ordered that Bret and Lorient be defended to the "last man and last bullet". The intent was to deny the Allies critical, deep-water port facilities to prevent them from supplying their armies.

Brittany: US 3rd Army Breakdown



Historically Brest held out until late September, and Lorient until the end of the war.

When the US 3rd Army reaches St Malo, the next time a card calls for US 3rd Army to advance, it is split into its two corps: VIII Corps and XV Corps. Both Corps then advance.

VIII Corps attacks Brest and Lorient, XV Corps advances on Rennes. Each time a requirement to advance is shown on a card, advance **BOTH** corps. Any attack/defense/Air Power/Patton modifiers apply to both.

If VIII Corps arrives in the same space as XV corps, merge them back. Replace the two counters with the US 3rd Army counter.

Losing Brest or Lorient results in a -2 Hitler Approval Level (-2 for each port).

Hitler's attitude toward the fortress ports in Brittany was one of absolute, uncompromising, and defensive intransigence, driven by his directive to hold them "to the last man, to the last cartridge". That is reflected here in the harsh penalties to the Player if they are lost.

Ignore the Upgrade Armies event for 3rd Army. It is always a 4 strength Army, or two 2-strength corps.

Note that if US 1st Army arrives at Avranches, any US 3rd Army advances listed on the same card apply immediately.

Example

US 1st Army advances to Avranches, thus activating US 3rd Army. The event card is #47 *Red Ball Express*, so US 3rd Army can attack St Malo. It wins that battle and advances to the St Malo space. As per the rules, 3rd Army marker is replaced by the VIII Corps and XV Corps markers (see diagrams)



Bradley Halt Order (Card # 42)

If US 3rd Army is split into its two corps, only retreat XV Corps (if it has reached Le Mans). Otherwise retreat the US 3rd Army marker.

Alencon Counter-Attack (Card # 46)

If there are no panzer units or kampfguppen on the board, or if 3rd Army has not yet been activated when this card is played, ignore its instructions.

Hitler Intervention Cards

When the player draws a *Hitler Intervention* card he may make a Hitler Approval roll. If the roll passes, ignore the card. I

If not, the player must move one or two panzer divisions (according to the instructions on the card) and then attack the target given on the card. The redeployed panzer units **must** participate in the attack.

The player may instead choose to implement the instructions on the card in which case no Hitler Roll is made.

If moving panzer units would break stacking rules, do not move the units, but attack with as many panzer units are in the space (up to supply limits). Panzer units may be redeployed from the map or Strategic Reserve at no cost. All nebelwerfer units in the space must attack in addition to designated panzer units.

No Transport Check is needed for this redeployment, but 1 supply point is expended for the attack as normal.

If the attack succeeds, increase Hitler Approval by one as for normal attacks.

Example



US ARMY ISOLATED

There is a possibility that one or other of the US Armies could be forced into a retreat which leaves the other isolated.

See example:



German 2nd Panzer unit in St Malo attacks US 3rd Army in Avranches. This is 2 vs 5 (Bocage is 1) so requires a 4 or more to win. Let's assume the roll succeeded.



The US 3rd Army was defeated by 2nd Panzer and forced back to its start box. 2nd Panzer advances to Avranches, meaning US 1st Army's line of communication is cut. As long as this persists, US 1st Army cannot attack.

Similarly, if the Germans were to occupy Avranches and US 3rd Army is in Brittany or at any point further on its track, that Army (or its constituent corps) cannot attack until Avranches is retaken.

HOUSEKEEPING

During this Phase, certain procedural steps are performed in the order listed below before either the game ends or is continued to the next turn.

German Defeat

- 1) If an Allied unit occupies the 0 space on its track – OR – Hitler Approval has reached -2 the game ends immediately in defeat.
- 2) At the end of the first deck (or on drawing Card #25 to shuffle in the mid deck), if S Caen and Avranches are both Allied controlled the game ends immediately in a German defeat.

This is intended to prevent the tactic of withdrawing to the Falaise area and building a hedgehog defense around the gap which was not tenable historically (not least because Hitler would never have allowed a retreat on this scale)

Refresh the Map. Remove all Strength Modifier markers and set aside.

Victory

The German player loses if any Allied Armies reach space 0 (Falaise) before the completion of the last turn. He also loses if N. Caen and Avranches are Allied controller when Card 20 is played, or if Hitler Approval reaches -2.

Obviously card #20 (Operation Goodwood) could be drawn early and this victory condition becomes nullified but as long as it hasn't been drawn the Player must defend these locations at all cost (as ordered by Hitler).

FALAISE SCENARIO

This learning scenario gives a quick game which can be used to learn the core concepts in the game. It uses only the third deck of cards. With only 12 cards, it is playable in about 30 minutes.

Follow these steps to set up the game:

1. Place the 1st US Army (strength 4) in the Flers (2) space.
 2. Place the 3rd US Army (strength 2) in the Alençon space.
 3. Place the 2nd British Army (strength 4) in the Mont Pinçon space.
 4. Place the 1st Canadian Army (strength 3) in the Falaise space.
- Reinforcements are at level “3”
 - Hitler Approval is at level “3”
 - Supply is at level “2”

Place one 88mm FlaK in Virelloss

Place one 88mm FlaK in Hill 112

Place one Kampfgruppe in the Falaise Gap

Place one Nebelwerfer unit in Argentan

Optional Rules

1. This rule supposes the Germans had followed Rommel's advice to position Panzer forces near the coast. Panzer Lehr starts the game in Carentan; 12SS Panzer starts in Lebieux Wood.
2. Use of Attack/Defense Grid:

As an [optional] aid to remind the player of the attack and defense strengths in a battle, once all the modifiers have been added in, a chart and markers are provided to keep track of this.

So to repeat the earlier example of an attack by the British on Bayeux:

On Turn 3, the event card drawn is #14 *Operation Epsom*. The weather is overcast. The military section shows advances by 2nd British and 1st Canadian army so 2nd British will attack Bayeux (space 5 on the British 2nd Army track is a town with a defense value of 1).

The Air Power section lists Jabos and Carpet Bombing but since the weather is overcast these are **not** available this turn.

Jabos are placed on the listed army or armies, and remain there for any German counter-attack, i.e., they provide modifier to attack and defense strengths. Carpet Bombing modifiers only apply to attacks.

Where the card says +1 Attack Strength 2nd BRIT, this means an additional +1 to the overall Attack Strength

Bayeux contains 21st Panzer (+2) plus two Nebelwerfer rocket units (+2) and one Nebelwerfer giving a defensive DRM of +5.

Total Defense Strength = 6 (1 for Bayeux plus 5 modifiers)

Total Attack Strength = 3 (+1 Attack Strength listed on card, +2 Montgomery)

Place the Allied Attack Strength marker in the 3 space, the German Defense Strength in the 6 space:

Attack/Defense Values				
0	1	2	ATTACK STRENGTH	4
5	DEFENSE STRENGTH	7	8	9
10	11	12	13	14
15	16	17	18	19